

Praveer Sinha, Chairman and Managing Director of Tata Power.

AHEAD OF THE CURVE

Sinha, who has led Tata Power since May 2018, was reappointed in May 2023 for another four years to drive the company's sustainability agenda. His decades of experience in the power sector not only shaped the company's ambitions but also made him the choice for the **Green Growth Visionary** category at this year's BT-PwC India's Best CEOs Awards.

At the helm of one of India's largest integrated power companies, Sinha says that Tata Power isn't striving to be the biggest in capacity but be a key player in clean energy with the best returns. "We are democratising energy consumption, and renewable energy gives us that opportunity," he says.

Sinha, 61, foresees a huge transformation in the sector— not just in how energy is produced but also in how it is used and exchanged across platforms. This vision has driven Tata Power to offer bundled service solutions for large commercial and industrial consumers, residential users, and utility-scale operations.

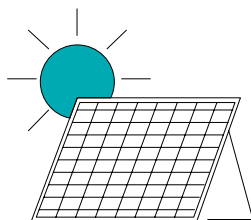
"Our focus, over a period of time, has gone from pure solar and pure wind to a hybrid of solar-wind and storage. It can be battery storage, or it can be pump storage, but how do we profile and give the solution which meets the consumer requirement 365 days. I think this is something that no other company is offering," says Sinha.

MULTI-PRONGED STRATEGY

In order to meet different kinds of energy needs, Tata Power is leveraging multiple clean energy technologies, including solar, wind, hydro, hybrid, floating solar, and advanced storage solutions like battery and pumped storage systems. Breaking away from traditional utility models, the company is bundling its services into a digital Energy-as-a-Service (EaaS) platform, enabling in-

FUTURE PROJECTS

- 01 **4.3 GW solar manufacturing plant in Tamil Nadu**
- 02 **Solar rooftops to 3 million households in the next three years**
- 03 **Solar micro grids in rural India**
- 04 **5,000 MW renewable energy projects in Bhutan**
- 05 **To fast-track green energy supply in 10,500 circuit km of transmission line by FY30**



dividuals, businesses and communities to access round-the-clock clean energy tailored to their needs. Tata Power is also a leader in rooftop solar and already completed 1,00,000 installations. It aims to reach three million households in the next three years, supporting the PM Surya Ghar Yojana.

"How do we bring the ability to individual consumers to produce energy and use it and give some to the grid? The other model we are working on giving to a cluster of homes or a cluster in colonies. Many of these solutions are democratising the use of energy so that consumers are not stuck with a monopolistic supplier," he says.

REACHING BEYOND

India's solar expansion has long been hindered by its reliance on imports, particularly from China, a vulnerability exposed further by the Covid-19 pandemic. To address the supply chain challenges for solar modules, Tata Power recently inaugurated the country's single largest solar cell and module manufacturing unit in Tamil Nadu. The 4.30 GW photovoltaic cell and module manufacturing unit has been built by the company's solar manufacturing arm, TP Solar Ltd., with an investment of ₹4,300 crore.

"I think with the manufacturing that we have set up, we have a very good supply chain now. We are not dependent on someone else," he says.

The indigenous production of solar cells marks a significant milestone, supporting India's ambitious clean energy goals and reducing reliance on imports. The solar cell production, currently at a 2 GW capacity, will enhance Tata Power's ability to meet the growing demand for high-quality, domestically produced solar components, especially for large-scale capacity-addition projects.

Over the next five years, Tata Power plans to invest ₹1.25 lakh crore in the energy sector. Of this, 50-55% would be in the renewable space, 30% in transmission and distribution, and about 20% in